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The Wego travel app (Android and iOS) gives you hundreds of airfare options and hotel rates in 20 languages <http://digit.in/WegoTravel>



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Psst...

Wanna Know a Secret?

The veiled world of anonymous social sharing is growing. We dissect the apps, the phenomenon and the culture that their adoption is creating

Samir Alam

readersletters@digit.in

Twenty years ago, almost everyone online had nicknames or “handles” to keep things private. Chat rooms, hubs where people could meet and exchange ideas but remain buffered with usernames that often bordered on the ridiculous, combined with questions like “ASL?” (Age/Sex/Location) became the trigger to invent a new identity. Then, came along social networking and sharing sites and everything changed. The mysterious RustyWagonWheel37 on Yahoo Chat was revealed to be Mrs. P.K. Girpade, your Maths tutor.

Online strangers who seemed mysterious and interesting became boring realities rarely matching up to their online personas. Private suddenly became public and online profiles became an open access history book of everyone’s likes, activities and bad humour. Since then, we’ve seen little change in the fabric and nature of social networks. Until now, with the rise of anonymous social networking.

Anonymity: The next liberation movement

The phrase “anonymous social networking” seems like an oxymoron at first glance. After all, isn’t the whole point of having a digital social network



India's very own anonymous social sharing app is available on Android. An iOS version is expected very soon

to share and communicate with your friends and family? Well yes. But you must wonder how often do people even do that in real life? Facebook is great when you need to organise an event, share photographs and videos from shared activities, follow topics and people you like, promote interests and causes, and occasionally chat with friends, but how much of ourselves do we actually release into the network?

Recent research has shown that only about 10 percent of social networks users are outwardly active with 90 percent doing nothing more than consuming information. And with more than half of the timelines being taken up by liked topics and celebrity pages this seems to make a lot of sense. There are the occasional spurts of comments

and likes over images, but rarely do they result in emotional catharsis for passive users. Add to that the constant political correctness of different intermixed social groups, which keeps everyone reserved and calculating. Doesn't seem very social now, does it?

It's in the midst of this boring status quo that we're seeing the rise of anonymous social networking. Mobile apps such as 'Secret', 'Whisper' and 'Confess' allow users to share whatever is on their minds without having to worry about it being traced back to them. A variety of encryption and network engineering techniques created for these type of networks enable users to share their thoughts without fear of shame or consequences. The social networking part may seem